Meridian Commercial Bank Ltd.

SOP: Retail & Corporate Customer Onboarding

SOP ID: MCB-OPS-SOP-021 | Version 3.1 | Effective: 1 May 2026 | Owner: Head - Customer Operations

This SOP is a fictional training document.

Step 1: Application Intake

The relationship manager (RM) collects the account opening form and the documents listed in Annexure 1. The RM shall confirm the customer's identity face-to-face or through V-CIP. Incomplete applications must not be forwarded to operations.

Step 2: Document Verification

The operations maker verifies each OVD against the original, or digitally through the Aadhaar and DigiLocker integrations. The maker records the OVD type, number, issue and expiry dates. Expired passports and driving licences must not be accepted.

Step 3: Screening

The maker initiates name screening for the customer, BOs, directors and signatories. Any match with a score of 85 percent or above is routed to the Compliance Screening Desk. The account shall not be activated until all alerts are cleared.

Step 4: Risk Categorisation

The system proposes a risk rating from the matrix in Annexure A of the Policy Manual. The maker may only upgrade the rating, not downgrade it. A downgrade requires written approval from Compliance.

Step 5: Enhanced Due Diligence Trigger

For High-risk customers, the maker raises an EDD task. The RM must provide source-of-wealth evidence within 10 business days. The Business Head approves the case; PEP cases additionally need Principal Officer concurrence.

Step 6: Checker Review

The checker independently validates the file. A file may be returned to the maker at most twice; a third return shall be escalated to the Operations Manager. Target turnaround time for the checker is 1 business day for retail and 3 business days for corporate customers.

Step 7: Account Activation and Welcome Kit

Upon approval, the account is activated and the welcome communication is dispatched. For non-face-to-face customers, the first transaction must be a credit from the customer's own account at another regulated bank.

Step 8: Records and Quality Assurance

Scanned documents are indexed in the document management system within 2 business days. Quality Assurance samples 10 percent of corporate and 5 percent of retail files each month and reports defect rates to the Principal Officer.

Annexure 1 - Document Checklist

Customer Type	Mandatory Documents
Resident individual	OVD, PAN or Form 60, photograph, address proof (if not on OVD), income declaration
Non-resident individual	Passport, visa/OCI, overseas address proof, PAN, foreign tax identification number, NRE/NRO declaration
Private limited company	Certificate of incorporation, MoA/AoA, PAN, board resolution, list of directors, shareholding pattern, OVDs of signatories, BO declaration
Partnership firm	Registration certificate, partnership deed, PAN, OVDs of partners, BO declaration
Trust	Registration certificate, trust deed, PAN, OVDs of settlor, trustees and beneficiaries, source of funds declaration

Annexure 2 - Turnaround Time and Escalation

Stage	Owner	TAT	Escalation
Document verification	Maker	1 business day	Operations Manager
Screening alert clearance	Compliance Desk	2 business days	Principal Officer
EDD approval	Business Head	5 business days	CCO
Checker review	Checker	1-3 business days	Operations Manager